STANDARD OPERATING PROCEDURE	G-9600

	SARPY COUNTY SHERIFF'S OFFICE PAPILLION * NEBRASKA **GREG LONDON** **SHERIFF**	DATE ISSUED 06/12/06	DATE REVISED **05/29/08**	DATE REVIEWED 02/02/25
		APPROVED: *GREG LONDON*		

CHAPTER TITLE	RESOURCES
GENERAL	

SUBJECT	CROSS REFERENCE
A CHILD IS MISSING ALERT	G-9500 AMBER ALERT P-5100 MISSING PERSONS/JUVENILES

I. Purpose:

The purpose of this policy is to establish procedures for utilizing A Child Is Missing Inc. to report a missing or lost person.

II. Policy:

The Sarpy County Sheriff's Office understands the importance of the rapid location of lost or missing children. To facilitate the location of missing children or elderly persons, the Sheriff's Office shall utilize A Child Is Missing Inc. (ACIM). This non-profit organization is devoted to assisting law enforcement in the search and early recovery efforts during the initial hours of a child/elderly person's disappearance via a rapid-response neighborhood notification system utilizing a high-tech telephone program. ACIM places up to 1,000 calls in 60 seconds to the area of the missing person. These calls have a high listen rate and increase the awareness of the missing person in the appropriate area.

III. Procedures:

A. Types of Cases Handled by ACIM: All children, infants to 18 years of age, elderly persons (often with Alzheimer's), college students, mentally challenged and unconscious individuals without identification.

1. Any lost or missing juvenile, elderly person, or mentally challenged individual.

2. Located children (infants to six years): program may be used to locate parents.

3. Runaways: when foul play is suspected.

4. First time runaways: with or without foul play suspected.

5. Major emergencies that involve children on a case by case basis.

6. Stranger/parental abductions.

7. Missing pregnant women.

8. Unconscious persons without I.D.: program may be used to locate relatives or guardians.

9. Located mentally challenged persons: program may be used to locate relatives or guardians.

B. Notifying ACIM: ACIM may be notified by a supervisor or command officer.

1. The ADC shall be notified prior to contacting ACIM.

2. The Sheriff's Office Investigations Division shall have a phone assigned for ACIM and this phone shall be located in the Investigations Division office. The supervisor or command officer shall obtain the telephone number to be used for the public to call with information. The supervisor or command officer shall be responsible for assigning an employee to monitor the phone.

3. The employee assigned to monitor the ACIM phone shall complete an ACIM Contact form and advise the deputy in charge of the case regarding any possible leads as soon as possible.

4. ACIM may be used in conjunction with Amber Alert (see G-9500 Amber Alert).

5. ACIM may be contacted toll-free at (888) 875-2246 or (954) 492-4778.

6. ACIM is available 24 hours a day, 7 days a week.

a) ACIM will generally make phone calls 0600-2230 hours unless emergency notification is authorized by a supervisor or command officer.

7. ACIM requires the following information to begin making telephone notifications.

a) Name of missing person.

b) Description of missing person including:

(1) Date of birth.

(2) Gender.
(3) Nationality.
(4) Height and weight.
(5) Eye and hair color.
(6) Any additional characteristics such as glasses, tattoos, scars, piercing, etc.
(7) Clothing description.

c) Location last seen **with zip code.**

d) Nearest major intersection with accurate street names.

e) Residence if different than last known location.

f) Date and time last seen.

g) If friends or family have been notified.

h) If there is water or wooded areas near the last known location.

i) If the missing person has a vehicle, bicycle, or skate board.

j) If foul play is suspected, if so, who is the suspect.

k) If there was a confrontation prior to the person's disappearance.

l) If the person has a substance abuse problem.

m) If the person is taking medication.

n) The name of the investigating law enforcement agency including state and county.

o) The report number assigned.

p) The telephone number for the public to call if they have information.

q) The name of the deputy in charge of the case and contact information (telephone number and/or pager number) for the deputy in charge.

C. ACIM Actions:

1. After contact by a supervisor or command officer, an ACIM technician logs the pertinent information and makes a unique recorded message that will be

phoned out to the community asking citizens to check their yards and nearby areas for the missing person.

2. The public is instructed to call the provided Communication's number directly with any information regarding the missing person.

3. The target area is based on the last known location of the missing person using the address and zip code. Phone numbers are selected from 100 to 5,000 depending upon the area and the intensity of the search. Geo-mapping and satellite imagery programs are used to assist deputies in searching.

4. ACIM sends a Case Follow-up Report to the deputy in charge of the case to ascertain the effectiveness of the program. The deputy in charge is responsible for completing the form and returning it to ACIM.